implied that domestic communists might call upon Beijing and Moscow to aid them in attacking the Indian state. Furthermore, he asserted that India needed to strengthen itself because communist countries that India considered friendly at that time would not necessarily stay friendly.[99] In private, he was more direct, indicating to the American ambassador—presciently—that the Chinese threat would reach its climax in four to five years.[100]

The finance minister's statements about China and the Soviet Union created an uproar on the left in India, with accusations that the government was seeking to ally with the US. Publicly, Nehru neither repudiated nor endorsed Krishnamachari's remarks, merely noting that, as far as he was concerned, India had friendly relations with China and the Soviet Union. Asked about Krishnamachari's comment that India was in practice closer to the US, Nehru admitted that economically that was the case. Privately, Nehru told his minister that such public advocacy created problems since it gave ammunition to the Communist Party of India and caused potential embarrassment with Beijing and Moscow.[101]

Privately and publicly, Nehru acknowledged that the US was the "only country" that could help India "substantially."[102] And Krishnamachari's trip report, which leaked at the end of October, made evident that the core of the plan could only be saved with American, Japanese, and West German assistance. In parliament, he expressed hope that "sizeable" aid would be forthcoming from them and the World Bank.[103]

The Indian government was aware of the need to create a positive atmosphere for aid to India in the US. Under Secretary of State Christian Herter had stressed to Krishnamachari the importance of congressional sentiment, noting the adverse impact of any public airing of differences.[104] Dutt subsequently remarked to Nehru that there were "special reasons" not to rock the boat with the US.[105] The prime minister subsequently censured those in India critical of the US for not helping immediately.

Nehru also continued to express gratitude and welcome further assistance from the US. While publicly acknowledging disagreements with some American policies, Nehru stressed his appreciation for American "partnership in this tremendous adventure for India." At home and abroad, he noted the contribution of American aid to economic progress in countries like Japan, and that the US was seeking to play a constructive role in